

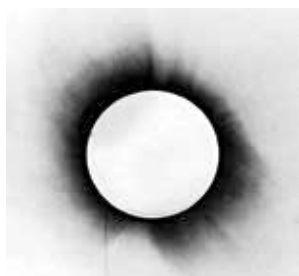
TEMPTATION

CRITIQUE

In this section, we put stuff through the grinder and closely examine what comes out; everything except gadgets, because there's more to life than just that

ALBUM REVIEW

All Our Gods Have Abandoned Us



All Our Gods Have Abandoned Us is the last album from British band Architects to have a contribution from guitarist and songwriter Tom Searle, who passed away last year due to cancer. Needless to say, he put his soul into his last work along with his band members. Describing the album subject to utmost brevity, the music is

heavy and complex without going completely bonkers. The riffs and timings, the mood is dark and energetic, and the lyrics are poignant, to say the least. All talented souls produce art but the message of this album is bordering transcendental, perhaps thanks to Tom's closeness to his personal end. He left behind his realisations for the world in a sonic package that resonates with your senses (if you're into screamo metal). The philosophically inclined, and those in search of the meaning of their life should definitely not miss this album. It's a piece of art that will mostly appeal to angry teenage souls.

Rating: ★★★★★

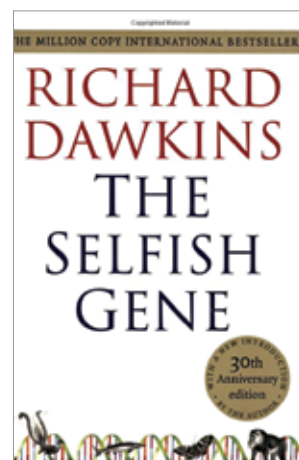
– Sahil Dawka

BOOK

The Selfish Gene

Richard Dawkins

It was quite a fortuitous coincidence that I started reading The Selfish Gene in the run up to an issue about memes – the very word was coined in this monumental book! The central theme revolves around understanding if true altruism exists in nature and whether it is the result of genes that are themselves altruistic. As you flip through the pages you'll be introduced to fascinating concepts such as kin selection, parental investment, and reciprocal altruism. As it turns out organisms are most often altruistic because they are engaged in the evolutionary game of iterative prisoner's dilemma that spans eons – basically tit for tat. Sounds like mind bending stuff right? The way Dawkins explains it though, even non-scientific readers would easily understand difficult concepts. Take for instance a possible cause for the skewed balance between genders when it comes to rearing the young. Most often in nature we find the female is burdened with this arduous task. The disparity starts from the very gamete stage where the female gametes are nutrition rich and fewer in number while



males go for numbers with minimal investment. You'll find many other examples; sometimes even for seemingly counterintuitive evolutionary traits. Genes are immortal and they will do whatever it takes for copies of themselves to be transmitted through the ages – even if this means controlling and coercing their survival machines (the animals they reside within) into strange acts. A nice bonus touch to the 30th anniversary edition are the interesting footnotes added by Dawkins where he examines how (if at all) his thoughts on a particular topic have changed since the first edition as a result of newer research.

Rating: ★★★★★

– Siddharth Parwatay



Bill Nye Saves the World
Bill Nye is returning to TV with a new reality show. *Actual* reality, the factual kind. The show will explore everything science, and in a world full of alt-facts, we really need this.

Release: April 21



Logan
The third and final installment in the Wolverine series and Hugh Jackman's last movie as the Wolverine. We're both, excited to see this one and sad to see Jackman go.

Release: March 2



Horizon: Zero Dawn
This action RPG is set in a world dominated by Robot Dinosaurs (*Robot Dinosaurs!*). Do you have what it takes to survive when you're not at the top of the food chain?

Release: February 28